

such as Apollo Hospitals, Max Healthcare, and Fortis Healthcare are infusing big money. The public sector manages about 30% of hospital beds.

Dr Ashutosh Raghuvanshi, MD & CEO of Fortis Healthcare, says technology will allow people to consult doctors over long distances without wasting a day travelling to the nearest big town or another metropolis.

The All India Institute of Medical Sciences, New Delhi, the gold standard in government healthcare, has integrated telemedicine and offers consultations to people in northeast India and Jammu & Kashmir. The Union Health Ministry's eSanjeevani,

governments was 2.1% of GDP in FY23, better than in previous years but much lower than the global average. The Fifteenth Finance Commission, whose recommendations cover the six years up to March 31, 2026, had recommended a public health expenditure of 2.5% of GDP.

Raghuvanshi says the government has to craft robust policies that support innovation, increase research funding, and improve healthcare delivery systems.

PHARMA REVOLUTION

According to the Department of Pharmaceuticals, India's pharmaceutical sector reached ₹10,790 crore in FY24.

therapies that target the underlying causes of NCDs," Matai says. "Our robust infrastructure, skilled workforce, cost-effective production capabilities, and enabling government policies will significantly expand India's role," Matai says.

India's success as a leading supplier of Covid-19 vaccines during the 2020 pandemic enhanced its reputation as the 'pharmacy of the world'. India is expected to be crucial in research, innovation, and developing next-generation vaccines and therapies. With all this technology invading the sector, managing the carbon footprint cannot be forgotten. Aakash Healthcare's Chaudhry, also its Managing Director, says advances in biotechnology, automation, and digitalisation will enhance pharmaceutical manufacturing efficiency and quality.



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a telemedicine service, offers consultations with doctors and specialists via smartphones or brick-and-mortar centres. By August 29, 2024, it had conducted over 284 million consultations.

The private sector Apollo TeleHealth has reached remote areas to offer consultations.

As for personalised medicine, Raghuvanshi of Fortis says, "Advances in genomics and biotechnology will allow for tailored treatments, improving patient outcomes." He says AI and machine learning will transform diagnostics, treatment planning, and disease prediction.

The combined public health expenditure of the Union and state

Anil Matai, Director General of the Organisation of Pharmaceutical Producers of India (OPPI), which represents research-based multinationals in India, says, "Digitalisation will democratise access to quality care, bringing medical expertise to even the most remote corners."

Matai says advances in genomics and biotechnology will allow personalised treatments, while AI and robotics will make diagnostics and surgeries more precise.

The pharmaceutical industry is focussing on innovative therapies that address the underlying causes of non-communicable diseases (NCDs) rather than merely managing symptoms. "There will be an increasing emphasis on developing innovative

A TESTING HUB

The diagnostics sector is also on the rise, driven by the increased prevalence of chronic diseases and a growing demand for early detection. TechSci Research, a management consulting firm, says the Indian diagnostics market will reach ₹2,324 crore by 2025.

Ameera Shah, Executive Chairperson and Whole-time Director of Metropolis Healthcare Ltd, says the diagnostics business will transform into point-of-care testing, which will become more accurate and accessible, especially in rural areas. Diagnostics will mesh with healthcare delivery, significantly increasing diagnostic volumes. Genomics and proteomics will allow doctors to tailor diagnostic solutions for every individual.

Shah says the average number of tests per sample will increase from three to nine or 10. "As technology advances, we will diagnose more diseases at earlier stages," she says.